

Reserve Storage

Also Remember...

■ Some newer digital cameras in the market now provide support for varied media types such as Iomega's 40 MB Click! disc, miniature CDs and memory cards to store images. The same media can also be used in PC-based drives for storage and retrieval of conventional data.

■ Cost of consumables varies from Rs 350 (for 100 MB Zip media) to Rs. 5,500 for the 2 GB Jaz discs.

Whether you need to back up important files or transport data from one computer to another, a wide array of external storage options are available to you. From a few megabytes of data to several gigabytes, you can be sure to find a unit that suits your storage requirements and, at the same time, remain budget-friendly.

There are a number of mediums available that facilitate storage of data outside your computer.

SMART TIPS

Capacity: This really depends on your application, or the quantities of data you need to back up. There is no real need to go overboard on storage capacity because prices tend to get on the higher side for both the media and the devices themselves.

Durability: Media that is enclosed in a casing of sorts will withstand the test of time better than exposed media. CD-ROM discs, which are the most popular means of data storage nowadays, are highly susceptible to scratches, which means that they could be rendered unusable after a short period of time.

Portability: If you share your data with others, it makes sense to consider options that are in widespread use.



Iomega's Zip drives, for example, are quite popular. The other options are the newer, Flash-memory based drives that utilise the USB port on any PC and make data portability even simpler.

Speed: Random access media such as hard drives, CD flavours and cartridges have the advantage of quick access to data stored on the media. If you have larger data backup requirements then go for a drive with higher speed to save time.

Interface: There are a wide variety of interface that are available, with options ranging from the parallel port to SCSI, USB and IEEE 1394 (or Firewire). While USB and parallel port drives work on most PCs the SCSI and Firewire give you faster transfer speeds. However, you will require either an adapter or a special port to use these.

	Focus on cost-effectiveness	Focus on capacity/speed
You need	Basic portability to transfer small to medium sized files.	Large data storage capacity and you will go for the maximum capacity available. Speed becomes a top concern as well. Price is not a problem.
Look for	Devices with a low price point and a storage capacity of 40 to 250 MB of data. USB is a better option.	A drive that can store approximately 1 to 2 GB of data on a single disc; SCSI or FireWire connectivity.
Our pick	Iomega Zip drive, Iomega Click!, Trekstore Thumbdrive	Iomega Jaz drive, Castlewood ORB drives
Price range	Rs 3,000 to Rs 10,000	Rs 17,000 to Rs 28,000



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